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A stray t-shower 73/56 • Tomorrow: Some sun 81/52 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, MAY 9, 2026 • \$4

FDA leader marked for ouster in shake-up

Agency has seen a wave of senior-staff departures and faced rising scrutiny

BY DAN DIAMOND
AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

The White House has signed off on a plan to replace Food and Drug Administration Commissioner Marty Makary after months of turmoil at the agency and criticism of some of his decisions, according to two individuals who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe internal operations.



The FDA has seen a wave of senior-staff departures and faced scrutiny from pharmaceutical industry groups, anti-abortion advocates and, at times, former FDA commissioners since Makary was installed as the agency's leader last year. White House and senior health officials have spent months discussing whether to reduce Makary's responsibilities or replace him altogether.

Makary's departure would be accompanied by broader changes to the FDA, after senior administration officials assessed the agency in recent months and identified opportunities for more efficient operations, the individuals said. They did not specify

SEE FDA ON A9

First batch of UFO files released to the public

Trump tells Americans to 'have fun' with declassified documents

BY DAN DIAMOND

Trump officials on Friday released their first batch of declassified files related to unidentified flying objects, following President Donald Trump's directive to make long-secret documents broadly available.

The Defense Department, the FBI, NASA and other agencies provided photos, videos and other documents, ranging from grainy videos that show objects that federal agencies say remain unexplained to redacted interviews with eyewitnesses. The files were posted at war.gov/ufo, with federal officials pledging to add more files on a rolling basis as they are declassified.

"The President is focused on providing maximum disclosure to the public, who can ultimately make up their own minds about the information contained in these files," White House spokeswoman Anna Kelly said in a statement. "The American people asked, and President Trump delivered — enjoy!"

Trump also instructed Americans to "have fun" with the files in a post on his Truth Social platform. "Whereas previous Admin-

SEE UFO ON A5

Voter-passed Virginia map overturned

BY GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER
AND PATRICK MARLEY

RICHMOND — The Supreme Court of Virginia has invalidated the referendum that could have given Democrats four extra seats in the U.S. House, a major win for Republicans who started a national redistricting war to maintain control of the chamber.

The Virginia court ruled that the General Assembly violated the state constitution in establishing the ballot measure approved

DEMOCRATS WERE POISED TO GAIN 4 SEATS

State high court says referendum violated constitution

April 21 by a slim majority of voters. A 4-3 majority of the court ruled the legislature had improperly submitted the referendum to voters, rendering the results "null and void." The court restored the pre-referendum map that was adopted in 2021, which produced a current slate of six Democrats and

five Republicans representing Virginia in the House.

The decision negates a bruising election battle that saw Democrats spend more than \$64 million to persuade Virginians to draw new maps, casting the state as the key to winning a blue House majority and slamming the

brakes on the administration of President Donald Trump. Now the party faces a catastrophic situation where the electoral playing field is tilted against them nationally even if voters mount an anti-MAGA rebellion this November.

National Republicans secured their advantage by changing district lines to give themselves an edge in flipping 14 seats across six states, and they may pick up as many as four more as several Southern states move to redraw their maps after a favorable U.S.

Supreme Court ruling. California voters passed a ballot measure giving Democrats the edge in flipping five seats, and a court ruling in Utah helps the party win another.

"Today is a deeply troubling moment for Virginia, the nation, and our entire democracy," Virginians for Fair Elections, the Democratic group that organized the redistricting effort, said in a statement. "It comes at a moment when voting rights are already

SEE VIRGINIA ON A8

Spain readies for evacuations



AP

Passengers on the hantavirus-hit cruise ship MV Hondius scan the horizon Wednesday. The vessel is set to arrive Sunday at the Spanish island of Tenerife, and passengers will be taken to a "completely isolated" area. **Story, A13**

Rubio's warm embrace in Rome offers a contrast

BY ADAM TAYLOR
IN ROME

Secretary of State Marco Rubio presented a more diplomatic side of the Trump administration in meetings this week with Italy's premier and the leader of the Catholic Church. But he offered no promises that the amity would last.

As Rubio told reporters Friday afternoon, as he prepared to depart the Italian capital, President Donald Trump may well continue his harsh public criticisms of Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni or Pope Leo XIV, the first U.S.-born pontiff, if they do not align with his views on Iran and other issues.

"The president will always speak clearly about how he feels

about the U.S. and U.S. policy," Rubio said when asked by reporters here if he would advise Trump to limit his verbal attacks, adding that "the president of the United States is always going to act on what's in the best interest of the United States."

The remarks were a dose of hard realism as the secretary closed out a trip portrayed by the

State Department in warm, colloquial terms — and widely viewed in Italian media as an attempt by Washington to mend ties after Trump in recent weeks branded both Meloni and Leo as weak after they distanced themselves from his war on Iran.

Rubio, a practicing Catholic, had brought his wife to Thursday

SEE RUBIO ON A12

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY
AND FEDERICA COCCO

The share of American men in the labor force reached a record low this spring, fueled by baby-boomer retirees and young men who are dropping out to study or because they are disabled or sick. The only time it has been lower was during the first two months of the coronavirus pandemic in 2020.

Labor Department data released Friday showed that 1 in 3 American men were not working or looking for a job in April.

The labor market has weakened since early 2025, with most job opportunities concentrated in areas typically dominated by women, including health care and private education. At the same time, several male-dominated industries, including manufacturing, transportation and mining have shed jobs, leaving a mismatch between typical skill sets and job opportunities for men.

"It's not all retirement and education. ... There are guys just dropping off the planet. They're not looking after their kids. They're not in school. They're not in the labor force," said Betsey Stevenson, a professor of economics at the University of Michigan. "Across the board when we look at men, we see challenges

SEE LABOR ON A15

Musk confidante central to OpenAI court battle

Shivon Zilis, mother of four of his children, opens up about her role

BY ELIZABETH DWOSKIN,
GERRIT DE VYNCK
AND FAIZ SIDDIQUI

OAKLAND, CALIF. — Shivon Zilis had her back against the wall.

For more than six years, the tech executive had worked largely outside the public eye as a trusted confidante to Tesla CEO Elon Musk and his three co-founders at the artificial intelligence start-up OpenAI. But now, as the company's recently launched ChatGPT soared, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman had discovered that Musk was planning a rival AI venture and poach-

ing talent from the start-up, according to federal court testimony this week.

Zilis, who served on OpenAI's board and had secretly had two children with Musk, urgently texted a friend.

"Have to resign OpenAI board btw," Zilis wrote in February 2023 to a person identified in her contacts as Shahini Rubicon Fluffer. Musk's "effort has become well known."

"You ok?" the friend responded, adding an expletive.

"When the father of your babies starts a competitive effort and will recruit out of OpenAI there is nothing to be done," Zilis replied.

The exchange, released Wednesday during Zilis's testimony in the U.S. District Court for the Northern District of California, marked the culmination

SEE MUSK ON A18



JUSTIN MERRIMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Tiny airport devastated by Spirit's demise

Cindy Reed, right, and Yukari Woodland, workers at Arnold Palmer Regional Airport, pack up Thursday after the Pennsylvania airport suddenly lost all its commercial traffic. **Story, A6**

IN THE NEWS

Denaturalization push The DOJ has launched a dozen new cases as the White House seeks to strip U.S. citizenship from those accused of immigration fraud or hiding crimes. **A4**

FEMA grants These blue states aren't getting fire prevention money from the Trump administration, a Post analysis shows. **A2**

THE NATION **Immigrants** are giving up their asylum cases and leaving the U.S. in soaring numbers. **A4** **Strong tornadoes** hit Mississippi. Here's what made them unusually dangerous. **A10**

THE WORLD **Ahead of Trump's** trip to China next week, a bipartisan group of U.S. lawmakers is urging him to seek the release of publisher Jimmy Lai, imprisoned in Hong Kong since 2020. **A13**

THE ECONOMY **Employers** added 115,000 jobs in April, notching a strong gain for the economy as it faces headwinds from soaring fuel prices. **A14** **U.S. stocks** rose to new records after the latest sign that the job market is doing better than economists thought. **A14**

STYLE **No movie** can perfectly replicate the live music experience, but "Billie Eilish" works an immersive magic where every seat is the best seat. **B1**

SPORTS **Sonny Styles**, wearing a Hall of Famer's number, feeds expectations for the Commanders. **B7**

THE REGION **Kenyan R. McDuffie**, a top contender in the Democratic primary for D.C. mayor, gained a big backer in former mayor Anthony Williams. **B13** **Shera**, at 21 the oldest lion at the National Zoo, was euthanized by her keepers after suffering a decline in mobility. **B13**

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